

**Regular Meeting
Monday, June 3, 2019
Medford School Committee
Council Chambers**

Present: Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruggiero, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Burke, Superintendent Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Assistant Superintendent Kirsteen Patterson.

Roll Call and Salute the Flag - Meeting called to order at 7:08PM.

Approval of Minutes of May 20, 2019 - Motion to approve offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Mr. Kreatz, motion passes.

Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds and Approval of Payrolls - Ms. DiBenedetto asked a number of questions for clarification. Ms. Patterson addressed all of her questions. Motion to approve offered by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot. Roll call vote.

7 affirmative

0 negative

Motion passes.

Motion to suspend the rules to take papers 2, 3, and 4 out of order offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Recognition of Medford High School Ethics Bowl Team - Dr. Nicole Chiesa - The students performed very well in the Ethics Bowl. Special thanks to Mr. Esner and Ms. Mahoney for their support advising and chaperoning the trip to North Carolina. The students received certificates for their participation in the Ethics Bowl.

Report on 2019 High School Science & Engineering Fairs - Rocco Cieri - Participation in these fairs is very ambitious and we are proud of the students. Thank you to Tufts University for their support. I would like to recognize Albert Farrah. Medford has had great showing at the International Science and Engineering Fair (ISEF) in Phoenix, Arizona. Albert Farrah received a certificate.

Recognition of Seal of Biliteracy - Vilma Bibeau - This year we are proud to recognize 18 students with the Seal of Biliteracy. Thank you so much for your support and as we celebrate these students. Ms. Bibeau also read a letter from the College Board commending student Joseph Schmidt for not only achieving a 5 on the AP Spanish exam, but he got every possible point. Ms.

DiBenedetto - We do not offer Portuguese as a class. Ms. Bibeau - That is the beauty of the Seal of Biliteracy, that students can take it in languages we do not teach. Ms. DiBenedetto - Maybe we should explore teaching Portuguese.

Recommendation to Approve Field Trip - Dr. Bernadette Ricciardelli and Marie Nyland - Ms. Nyland - I would like to present a request for the first ever trip to Paris. It would take place during April vacation and students will not miss any school days. Ms. DiBenedetto - Can you clarify the cost of the trip. Also the insurance is not optional, we voted on that. Ms. Nyland - Yes, this is the same company that coordinates the Italy trip so they are aware of the insurance requirement. The price is \$3,000 including the non-optional insurance. That includes flights, tours, meals, hotels. They have all put down a \$200 deposit. If this is approved, we will have a meeting next week to meet the parents. Ms. DiBenedetto - How are chaperones chosen? Ms. Nyland - Based on experience. Ms. Van der Kloot - Will the list of students be given to the school nurse? Ms. Nyland - Yes, she has signed it. Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Recommendation to Appoint Dr. Peter Cushing to Position of Assistant Superintendent - Dr. Edouard-Vincent spoke about Dr. Cushing's experience and expertise. Dr. Cushing spoke about his excitement to take on the new role and his excitement to be a part of the Medford Public Schools. Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Motion to revert to regular order of business offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion carries.

Report of Committees - Support Services Sub Committee - Paul Ruseau - Motion to accept the report and place on file offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Report of Committees - Rules Sub Committee - Kathy Kreatz - We have adjusted the Meals Charge Policy. Ms. DiBenedetto - I got a text from a community member offering to help us write grants for breakfast after the bell. Motion to adopt changes to the policy offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Ms. Kreatz. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative
Motion passes.

Report of the Superintendent - Superintendent's Updates and Comments - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent - It was a fantastic action packed weekend of events here in Medford: Diversity Day at Tufts Park and the Cardboard Canoes Races at Wright's Pond on Saturday, and then Medford Day on Sunday. This weekend was definitely a great example of our One Medford, One District City.

This is also an event-filled week at the Medford Public Schools:

Tomorrow is graduation for the Curtis Tufts High School - 11am - at the Irish American Club. Also, tomorrow at the Brooks Elementary School, at 3 PM, CCSR will host a ribbon cutting for the newly painted playground.

Tomorrow is also the beginning of Spring MIAA Tournament Play for the following Mustang Sports Teams: Boys Tennis - will play at North Andover tomorrow at 4pm & Boys Lacrosse - will also play tomorrow at Westford Academy at 5pm.

Tristen Howard of the Outdoor Track Team placed 4th in the State in the 200 meters this weekend and qualified for the New England Championships which will be held this Saturday. Tomorrow evening, the Voke's Robotics and Engineering Program will host their annual Open House from 6-8pm. They have extended the invite to all, but especially to our middle school students and parents.

Our new football coach, John Curley will also be hosting a meeting of students and their parents who might be interested in playing football in the fall, tomorrow evening at 6pm in Cafe 2.

Graduation is Wednesday, June 5th at 6pm at Tufts University

Friday, June 7th, from 8 - 9am, the Guidance Department will be hosting Coffee with the Counselors, for interested parents in Cafe 1 of Medford High School.

Friday we will also cut the ribbon for the new Orchard & Outdoor Classroom at MHS at 2:30pm in the inner Courtyard.

Saturday, June 8th - Medford's CCSR Slavery Memorial Unveiling Ceremony will be held at 10:30am, at the Salem Street Burying Ground in Medford Square.

I would like to thank Armstrong Ambulance, for inviting the Voke's Health Assisting Program to a free "Stop the Bleed" workshop at their headquarters in Arlington during National EMS Week. We are appreciative of Armstrong's strong partnership with the Medford Public Schools. We celebrated the opening of the new Mustang Mall, now located in the front entrance of MHS, as well as, a new 3D sidewalk at the Roberts Elementary.

I want to recognize that Marie Cassidy was presented with an Honorary Doctorate of Public Service from Tufts University. We are so proud of all of her accomplishments, but are most proud about all the wonderful programs she provides, with no charge, to the families in our community.

I would like to thank District Attorney Marian Ryan for her generous donation towards the Junior Class Up All Night Party, which is held at Tufts University immediately following the Junior Prom. DA Ryan appreciates our commitment to providing a safe, substance free event for our students. I would also like to thank the MHS/MVTHS PTO, who organizes this youth event with Tufts University.

The Medford Vocational Technical High School is hosting its annual CTE Summer Camp for middle school students (grades 6-8) the week of June 17, 2019. The camp will be held from 8:30am – 12:30pm Monday, June 17th – Friday, June 21st. The programs that will be featured include: Business Marketing, Cosmetology, Graphic Design, Health Assisting and Robotics & Engineering. Cost per student = \$100. Interested parents can contact the Voke Main Office. In addition, Summer School is Tuesday, June 18th until Wednesday, July 31st. NO classes will be held Thursday, July 4th or Friday, July 5th. All registration and fee information can be found on the website and blog.

Report on SEPAC: Annual Update - Melanie McLaughlin and Tonya Sullivan - There are about 888 families that are receiving special education services and supports in Medford. Thank you to all participants in SEPAC and supporting each other. Membership includes students and families with IEPs and all interested parties, anyone is welcome to attend meetings. We advocate for every child in our community. Equality of opportunity means not that every child should get the same but that every child should get what they need. 18.8% of our student population receives special education services. One of our goals in the coming years is to help families with out-of-district placements to feel like they are a part of our community. We have a lower full-inclusion rate than the state, higher partial inclusion rate, and lower sub-separate rate than the state. We have hosted seminars and workshops at the Andrews Middle School. We have presented workshops at Bridgewater State University, Mass Down Syndrome Congress and Federation for Children with Special Needs Conferences. We were featured on NPR about our work in Universal Design for Emergency Preparedness. We have been discussing ways to include all students in out of school time. Disability is another aspect of diversity and we can celebrate disability pride. Our recommendation for the next year is to focus on a few topics so that we can see progress. 1. Create a district wide survey/inclusion report focusing on culture for inclusive practice and what improvements are needed. 2. Offer meaningful professional development on differentiated instruction and supplemental curriculum for teachers, paraprofessionals, and families. 3. Implement co-teaching model at elementary level. 4. Replace and create consistent language for inclusivity. 5. Publish school improvement plans on all school websites. 6. Expand inclusive communities for children with and without disabilities.

Accessibility is an important part of our community but it is also the law. We want to know how we can help and what next steps can be taken. Ms. Mustone - Is the number 770 families or 888? Ms. Medaglio - We gain families over the course of the year. 888 is correct. Ms. Mustone - I have concerns about budgeting. Do you expect to see more families with students with special

needs year over year? Ms. Medaglio - We gain preschoolers over the course of a year. Ms. McLaughlin - We would like to give an award in recognition of community members who exemplify the SEPAC mission of equity, diversity and inclusion for every child to Kathy Medaglio, Director of Pupil Services for her service and dedication to the children of Medford and their families.

Recommendation to Approve Teacher Unit (MTA) Pay Frequency Changes - Kirsteen Patterson - Motion to approve offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Report on K-12 Assessments - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent - This is a report on all the assessments that are given to students with the addendum of the MCAS tests students take. Mr. Ruseau - Thank you. The assessments that are not MCAS are where teachers and instruction live. I value the assessments teachers are giving. This report gives us an idea of what is really going on, beyond MCAS scores. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - The work that is happening over the course of the year is valuable. I will be able to maintain this report and select other pieces of data to show that we are moving the needle. Directors prepared this report to see the key levers we are looking at to prepare students to take the state assessments.

Ms. Van der Kloot - We have a follow-up report here about the Dyslexia programs, but we are not going to vote on it tonight. Will it be budgeted? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Yes.

Ms. Mustone - I spoke with a math teacher at the Roberts about where these assessments go. They said the data is reviewed and discussed with teachers and math coaches, and it informs instruction. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Yes, this is what I refer to when I say data-informed instruction. We need the assessments in order to have data.

Motion to accept this report and place on file offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, motion passes.

Report on Professional Development - Dr. Bernadette Ricciardelli - Medford Public Schools has a rich portfolio of professional development offerings for our faculty, paraprofessionals and administrators. In 2018-2019 we had 128 professional development offerings. We also offered 150 conferences. We reimbursed tuition to the level of \$40,000. We have grant funding amounting to \$15,577 for professional development. We are devoted to high quality professional development and responding to the needs of our district and faculty. Mr. Ruggiero - Can we have a report on denial versus approval rate. How do we compare to other districts? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We are generous with tuition reimbursement. We offer to pay for the tuition and then it qualifies you to have step-in-lane which means you get paid more in salary. \$40,000 is a commitment and an investment we are making every year. 150 conference days is a very

generous and reasonable number. Mr. Ruggiero - I would like to see how many conference days other area districts offer.

Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, motion passes.

Condolences: Margaret "Peggy" Kane; Shooting in Virginia Beach.

Motion to enter executive session offered by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot. Roll call vote.

7 Affirmative

0 Negative

Motion passes.

8:49pm